

Task 6 — Growth Instrumentation & North-Star Metrics

Data Analyst · Sprint B - Growth & Experimentation · Task Brief

DATA ANALYST

PlaceMux · Phase 3 · Task Brief

TASK 6 / 25

Deep Specialist · Expert

Sprint B - Growth & Experimentation · Mastery 68%

Focus

Define the north-star metric, guardrails and the growth model the company steers by.

What to build / complete

- A defined north-star metric with its input drivers
- Guardrail metrics that must never degrade
- A growth model connecting inputs to the north star

Execution — work through in order

Phase 3 gives you a goal and a bar, not a recipe. These stages are the discipline; the design decisions are yours to make and defend.

Stage A — Understand & set the bar

1. Re-read the Expected Output and the scoring parameters so you build to the bar, not past it.
2. Confirm every prerequisite and upstream input is actually in your hands, not merely promised.
3. Restate, in one sentence, what 'good' means here: Everyone knows the one number that matters, what drives it, and what must not break while pursuing it.

Stage B — Build: A defined north-star metric with its input drivers

1. Define the metric, its source & the decision

Define precisely what “A defined north-star metric with its input drivers” measures, which raw events it depends on, and which decision it changes. No decision, no metric.

2. Build the query/model on real data

Build the query/model on real production data — sampled if you must, but never synthetic.

3. Validate: reconcile, sanity-check, quantify uncertainty

Reconcile against a source system, sanity-check the magnitude, and state the uncertainty honestly.

4. Tie every number to an action & defend it

For every number, be ready to say where it came from and what action it triggers. Undefendable numbers do not ship.

Stage C — Build: Guardrail metrics that must never degrade

1. Define the metric, its source & the decision

Define precisely what “Guardrail metrics that must never degrade” measures, which raw events it depends on, and which decision it changes. No decision, no metric.

2. Build the query/model on real data

Build the query/model on real production data — sampled if you must, but never synthetic.

3. Validate: reconcile, sanity-check, quantify uncertainty

Reconcile against a source system, sanity-check the magnitude, and state the uncertainty honestly.

4. Tie every number to an action & defend it

For every number, be ready to say where it came from and what action it triggers. Undefendable numbers do not ship.

Stage D — Build: A growth model connecting inputs to the north star

1. Define the metric, its source & the decision

Define precisely what “A growth model connecting inputs to the north star” measures, which raw events it depends on, and which decision it changes. No decision, no metric.

2. Build the query/model on real data

Build the query/model on real production data — sampled if you must, but never synthetic.

3. Validate: reconcile, sanity-check, quantify uncertainty

Reconcile against a source system, sanity-check the magnitude, and state the uncertainty honestly.

4. Tie every number to an action & defend it

For every number, be ready to say where it came from and what action it triggers. Undefendable numbers do not ship.

Stage E — Integrate, verify & make demoable

1. Wire your work into the end-to-end flow and run the whole journey once, start to finish.
2. Present the model and show how a change in an input moves the north star, with real data.
3. Break it on purpose: force the failure path and confirm it degrades the way you designed.
4. Prepare a live demo on real data. Not slides, not screenshots, not 'it works on my machine'.

Done when (demoable by end of task)

- “A defined north-star metric with its input drivers” is complete, real, and demoable end-to-end.
- “Guardrail metrics that must never degrade” is complete, real, and demoable end-to-end.
- “A growth model connecting inputs to the north star” is complete, real, and demoable end-to-end.
- Good looks like: Everyone knows the one number that matters, what drives it, and what must not break while pursuing it.

Worry if any of these are true

- A north star that can be gamed without creating value.
- Growth pursued with no guardrails.
- Calling an experiment early because it looked good on day two.

Hand-off

- North star and guardrails to every role. Make sure the next person can pick it up without you.